

University of Idaho
Spring 2026

VAND4000-01: Writing the Syllabus
3 Credits

Instructor: Jane Vandal
Meeting: M/W/F, 1:00-1:50p
Location: TLC 123
Contact: vandalj@uidaho.edu, 208-885-1234
Office Hours: Th, 3:00-5:00p

Course Information

Course Description

This course introduces the principles and practices of designing an effective, student-centered syllabus. Students learn to articulate learning outcomes, align assessments, craft clear policies, and integrate inclusive and accessible teaching strategies. By the end of the course, participants will produce a complete, ready-to-use syllabus that reflects evidence-based instructional design.

Required Course Materials

Inclusive Access Textbook

- Vandal, J. (2020). *How to write a syllabus* (89th ed.). Vandal Press.

Additional Reading Materials

- Vandal, J. (2025). *How to develop an effective syllabus*. Vandalizer Inc.

Other Required Materials

- Include computer software requirements, as well as recommended non-text equipment, aids, materials, etc.

Assessment

Student Learning Outcomes

- **Learning Outcome #1:** Apply inclusive teaching and accessibility practices
 - Aligns with [University of Idaho Learning Outcomes](#): Technology proficiency; Professionalism and work ethic

- **Learning Outcome #2:** Communicate the syllabus as a learning tool and contract between instructor and students
 - Aligns with [University of Idaho Learning Outcomes](#): Communication; Leadership; Teamwork & collaboration
- Etc.

NOTE: Reference Bloom's Taxonomy to use active verbs to accurately demonstrate what you want your students to learn: <https://bokcenter.harvard.edu/taxonomies-learning>

Course Policies & Procedures

Attendance Policy

- **THE DEAN OF STUDENTS OFFICE DOES NOT EXCUSE ABSENCES.**
- Ensure your attendance policy is grounded in reason (e.g., missing one class is typically not grounds for the loss of an entire letter grade, etc.).
- Make clear to which extent grades are dependent on attendance and in-class participation.
- If you would like to discuss tailored approaches to attendance policies for your courses, please contact an Instructional Designer to set up a meeting (cetl@uidaho.edu).

Include clear expectations for attendance in class. Below is suggested language for an attendance policy.

As a student, you are responsible for your class attendance. **Regular attendance is an important part of your success in this course.** Participation in class activities is designed to support your learning and build community. Please review the expectations below:

Absences

In [accordance with UI academic procedures](#), I will provide reasonable opportunity for you to make up work when your absence from class results from any of the following:

- participation in official university activities and programs,
- personal illness,
- family illness and care, or
- other compelling circumstances.

To request an excused absence, please contact me as soon as possible, ideally before the missed class.

I will not require you to provide documentation for your absence, medical or otherwise. That said, **it will not be reasonable to make up work for excessive absences.** [If you have any specific attendance points in your course, please detail them and if there is a way to make them up. For example: “Please note, in this class, you earn 5 attendance points per class. There is no way to make these up if you are absent.”]

Unexcused and excessive absences may negatively affect your overall grade in the course. If you have excessive absences in the course, I may request a meeting to discuss your progress and strategies for staying on track in the course. I may also submit a CARE referral to connect you with additional support.

Makeup work for unexcused absences is not guaranteed and may receive reduced or no credit, depending on the activity.

If you are experiencing a situation that may qualify for short- or long-term disability accommodations, please [connect with CDAR](#) as soon as possible. Accommodations are not applied retroactively.

If you are experiencing an unexpected situation that is preventing you from completing your academic work for the semester, please [connect with a member of the CARE Team](#) in the Dean of Students Office to explore support options or a [Hardship Withdrawal](#).

Professional Courtesy

Communication is key. If you are experiencing challenges that impact your attendance, please reach out early. We want to help you stay engaged and successful. **You are accountable for timely communication of any challenges that may impact your attendance.** If you anticipate being absent from class, please email to let me know (use the course title in the subject line).

Late Assignments

Include **clear** expectations for late assignment acceptance in class. Below is suggested language for a late assignment policy.

Late assignments are not accepted without an approved extension before the due date.

Extensions

- If you anticipate difficulty meeting a deadline, you must request an extension **before the due date**.
- Extensions may be granted for circumstances for situations like those in UI's [Attendance Policy](#).
- When requesting an extension, provide a brief explanation of your situation and a proposed new submission date. Documentation is not required for an extension.
- Extensions are granted on a case-by-case basis, dependent upon assignment and individual situation.

Technology Issues

- Technology problems (e.g., computer crashes, lost files, Wi-Fi outages) **do not automatically qualify** for extensions. Please save/back up your work regularly and plan ahead.

Instructor Feedback Timeline

- Late submissions may receive delayed feedback.

Professional Courtesy

- Communicating early and honestly about challenges is part of developing strong academic and professional habits. If you are struggling, reach out—support and resources are available.

Assignment and Referencing Policy

All assignments are to be typed and professionally presented in [be clear about your expectations for assignment formatting, for example: Times New Roman or Aptos, 1.5 spaced, 10–12 pt. font]. You are expected to fully cite your sources in [your area's preferred type of citation: MLA, APA 7, etc.].

Academic Integrity

A core value at UI is the ideal of academic honesty and integrity. UI students live and work in a community which emphasizes their responsibility for helping to determine and enforce high standards of academic conduct. The University of Idaho expects all students to adhere to the highest standards of academic honesty, and to refrain from any action which

infringes upon academic freedom of other members of the community. Please review the [UI Student Code of Conduct](#) Article II - Academic Honesty.

Plagiarism

Plagiarism is using someone else's words, ideas, or work and presenting it as your own. This includes copying, rewording, or summarizing someone else's writing without giving them credit, as well as taking another person's ideas and putting them in new words without citing them.

Your assignments should be your original work. When using outside sources, you must cite them. If you use someone's exact words, put them in quotation marks and give proper credit. If you use their ideas, make sure you cite them even if you've rewritten the wording. When you fail to do so, it constitutes academic dishonesty.

Artificial Intelligence

Clearly communicating expectations regarding the use or no use of AI in your course is essential for fostering transparency and academic integrity. Students often express the following four concerns regarding AI guidelines in course syllabi:

1. Can we use ChatGPT for outlines or generating ideas?
2. Can we use the "free" Grammarly?
3. The AI use policy is not clear in the syllabus
4. The AI use policy is not communicated repeatedly throughout the semester

Be sure to consider these concerns.

Here are some commonly used AI tools by college students: ChatGPT; Grammarly; QuillBot; Google Gemini; Microsoft Copilot; DALL-E.

It is also important to consider if you will allow the use of language translations apps in your course. These may flag as AI. All students that attend UI must pass an English language proficiency exam. Unless a student has a CDAR accommodation specifically allowing the use of language translation apps, you are not required to allow the use of language translation apps in your course.

The following section provides a concise introduction and [sample language you may consider](#) including in your syllabus to guide students on appropriate AI use. You are welcome to use the language verbatim if you prefer. **It is highly recommended that you**

are as explicit as possible in your policy on what you will tolerate for use of AI in your course.

OPTION: AI Use Prohibited

As artificial intelligence tools become more widely available, it is important to clarify how they may or may not be used in this course. The following policy is designed to support your learning and ensure academic integrity.

The use of artificial intelligence (AI) tools—including but not limited to ChatGPT, Copilot, Perplexity, Grammarly, image generators, and automated coding/writing assistants—is not permitted in this course.

Unauthorized use of AI tools is considered a form of unauthorized assistance and undermines the core learning objectives of the class. This course is intentionally designed to build foundational skills—such as critical analysis, discipline-specific reasoning, original writing, and independent problem-solving—that require your direct engagement. Using AI tools to generate or revise work may hinder the achievement of these objectives and may compromise the integrity of your academic development.

Any use of AI tools for coursework, unless explicitly allowed by the instructor for a specific assignment, will be treated as a violation of academic integrity and may result in sanctions as outlined in the [University of Idaho Student Code of Conduct](#). Students are responsible for reviewing and adhering to all university policies regarding academic honesty and should consult the Student Code of Conduct for further guidance.

OPTION: AI with Prior Permission

As artificial intelligence tools become more widely available, it is important to clarify how they may or may not be used in this course. The following policy is designed to support your learning and ensure academic integrity.

Artificial intelligence (AI) tools—including but not limited to ChatGPT, Copilot, Perplexity, Grammarly, image generators, and automated coding/writing assistants—may be used in this course only with prior instructor permission.

Unless permission is explicitly granted, all assignments must be completed independently and without assistance from automated tools.

If permission is given, students must (1) [cite any AI-generated material](#) using a clear attribution and appropriate citation format (e.g., APA, MLA, etc.) and (2) include a brief (2–3 sentence) note explaining how the tool was used, including the prompt or settings. Unauthorized or undisclosed use of AI tools will be considered a violation of academic integrity under the [University of Idaho Student Code of Conduct](#) and may affect your grade.

This practice helps you reflect on your learning process and ensures transparency in your academic work. If you're unsure how to document or cite AI use, please reach out or visit the [University of Idaho Writing Center](#) for support.

OPTION: AI with Acknowledgement

As artificial intelligence tools become more widely available, it is important to clarify how they may or may not be used in this course. The following policy is designed to support your learning and ensure academic integrity.

Artificial intelligence (AI) tools—including but not limited to ChatGPT, Copilot, Perplexity, Grammarly, image generators, and automated coding/writing assistants—may be used in this course if that use is properly documented and cited.

Students must (1) [cite any AI-generated material](#) using a clear attribution and appropriate citation format (e.g., APA, MLA, etc.) and (2) include a brief (2–3 sentence) note explaining how the tool was used, including the prompt or settings. Unauthorized or undisclosed use of AI tools will be considered a violation of academic integrity under the [University of Idaho Student Code of Conduct](#) and may affect your grade.

This practice helps you reflect on your learning process and ensures transparency in your academic work. If you're unsure how to document or cite AI use, please reach out or visit the [University of Idaho Writing Center](#) for support.

OPTION: AI with No Acknowledgement (not encouraged for use)

As artificial intelligence tools become more widely available, it is important to clarify how they may or may not be used in this course. The following policy is designed to support your learning and ensure academic integrity.

Artificial intelligence (AI) tools—including but not limited to ChatGPT, Copilot, Perplexity, Grammarly, image generators, and automated coding/writing assistants—may be used in this course. No documentation or citation is required.

Learning Civility

In any environment in which people gather to learn, it is essential that all members feel as free and safe as possible in their participation. To this end, it is expected that everyone in this course will be treated with mutual respect and civility, with an understanding that all of us (students, instructors, professors, guests, teaching assistants, etc.) will be respectful and civil to one another in discussion, in action, in teaching, and in learning.

Should you feel any classroom interactions do not reflect an environment of civility and respect, you are encouraged to reach out to me or an appropriate campus resource to discuss your concern.

Some appropriate campus resources to express a concern or request support include the **Dean of Students Office** (208-885-6757 or [VandalCARE referral](#)), the **Counseling and Mental Health Center** (208-885-6716), or the **Office of Civil Rights and Investigations** (208-885-4285).

Center for Disability Access & Resources (CDAR)

UI is committed to ensuring an accessible learning environment where course or instructional content are usable by all students and faculty. If you believe that you qualify for disability-related academic adjustments for this class, please contact CDAR to discuss eligibility. A current accommodation notification from CDAR is required before any modifications above and beyond what is otherwise available for all other students in this class will be provided.

Please be advised that disability-related academic adjustments are **not retroactive**. CDAR is located at the Bruce Pitman Building, Suite 127. Their phone number is 208-885-6307 and email is cdar@uidaho.edu.

For a complete listing of services and hours visit www.uidaho.edu/current-students/cdar.

Nondiscrimination Policy

UI has a policy of nondiscrimination on the basis of race, color, religion, national origin, sex, age, disability, or veteran status. This policy applies to all programs, services, and facilities, and includes, but is not limited to, applications, admissions, access to programs and services, and employment. Sexual harassment violates state and federal law and policies of the Board of Regents, and is expressly prohibited. UI also prohibits discrimination on the basis of sexual orientation, as stated in FSH 3215. The entire FSH can be accessed online at <http://www.webs.uidaho.edu/fsh>.

Complaints about discrimination or harassment should be brought to the attention of the **Office of Civil Rights and Investigations** (ocri@uidaho.edu, 208-885-4285). Retaliation for bringing forward a complaint is prohibited by FSH 3810.

UI Moscow Land Acknowledgement

The University of Idaho welcomes and respects all people. UI Moscow is located on the homelands of the Nimiipuu (Nez Perce), Palus (Palouse), and Schitsu'umsh (Coeur d'Alene) tribes. We extend gratitude to the indigenous people that call this place home, since time immemorial.

Course Schedule and Grading

The schedule may change. I will update you via [Canvas announcement](#), [UI email](#), or in [class](#) if changes occur. [See Canvas for assignment schedule in Module format \[optional but suggested to include for increased accessibility\]](#).

Unit	Assignment	Points Possible	Due Date
1	Assignment #1	50	Sunday Sept 14, 2025 @11:59p
1	Quiz #1	100	Sunday Sept 14, 2025 @11:59p
1	Lab #1	200	Sunday Sept 21, 2025 @11:59p
1	Unit #1 Exam	200	Sunday Sept 28, 2025 @11:59p
1	Unit #1 Attendance	40	etc.
1	Unit #1 Reflection	10	
2	Assignment #2	50	
2	Quiz #2	100	
2	Lab #2	200	
2	Unit #2 Exam	200	
2	Unit #2 Attendance	40	
2	Unit #2 Reflection	10	
3	Assignment #3	50	
3	Quiz #3	100	
3	Lab #3	200	
3	Unit #3 Exam	200	
3	Unit #3 Attendance	40	
3	Unit #3 Reflection	10	
4	Assignment #4	50	
4	Quiz #4	100	
4	Lab #4	200	
4	Unit #4 Exam	200	
4	Unit #4 Attendance	40	
4	Unit #4 Reflection	10	
	TOTAL	2400 points	

UI Grading Scale: A = 90-100%, B = 80-89%, C = 70-79%, D = 60-69%, F = <60%

University of Idaho Supports

Academic Supports	Contact	Location
Academic Coaching	acadcoaching@uidaho.edu	Idaho Student Union Building, 3rd Floor
Career Services	208-885-6121	Idaho Student Union Building, 3rd Floor
Center for Disability Access & Resources (CDAR)	208-885-6307	Bruce M. Pitman Center, Suite 127
International Programs Office (IPO)	208-885-8984	901 Paradise Creek St., LLC Building #3
Library	208-885-6534	850 S Rayburn Street
Writing Center	208-885-6644	Undergraduate: Library, 2nd Floor, Room 215 Graduate: Idaho Commons, Room 323

Health and Wellness	Contact	Location
Counseling & Mental Health Center	208-885-6716	Mary Forney Hall, Room 306
Nutrition Counseling	mrudley@uidaho.edu	Vandal Health Clinic – 831 Ash Street
Psychiatric Nurse Practitioner	208-885-6693	Vandal Health Clinic – 831 Ash Street
VandalCARE	208-885-6757	Teaching & Learning Center, Room 232
Vandal Health Clinic	208-885-6693	831 Ash Street
Vandal Health Education	208-885-4146	Student Recreation Center (SRC)

Vandal Food Resources	Contact	Location
Shoup Hall Food Pantry (“Vandal Food Pantry”)	208-885-6078	Shoup Hall, Room 105
Food Recovery Network Fridge	vlane@uidaho.edu or eropski@uidaho.edu	Niccolls Bldg. 2 nd Floor (follow signage in building)
AgSci Biotech Lounge (marked kitchen cabinets)	208-885-7984	AgSci Biotech Lounge Kitchen
Chas Basic Needs Kits	208-885-6757, askjoe@uidaho.edu	Teaching & Learning Center, Room 232

Vandal Food Resources	Contact	Location
Swipe Out Hunger	—	Submit CARE Referral to request
The Center	thecenterpalouse@gmail.com	822 Elm Street
Violence Prevention & Education	208-885-5044	Memorial Gym, Suite 109
West Side Food Pantry	www.inlandoasis.org	730 W Pullman Road, Suite 3

Emergency and Safety	Contact	Location
Moscow Police Sub-Station	208-882-2677	Memorial Gym, Room 110
Safe Walk (24/7)	1-208-885-SAFE (7233)	Call for an escort or ride; 24/7
Security Services	208-885-7054 or 208-874-7550	Memorial Gym, Room 111

VandalCARE

If you are concerned about a fellow Vandal (student/staff/faculty), submit a **VandalCARE referral** by visiting the [website](#) or scanning the QR code below.



If you consider the situation you are reporting an emergency, **call 911 immediately.**